worthy of the name should be able to quickly recognize and reject the formulaic character of this kind of aggressive political rhetoric, which reduces the complexities of the Arab-Israeli conflict to simple-minded notions of oppressor and oppressed—the former victims refashioned as present-day persecutors. To reinforce this malicious point and, with it, to brand Israel as today's leading—indeed, only—exemplar of state-sponsored criminality, apartheid South Africa is constantly cited. So, too, is Nazi Germany. Omar Barghouti, the founder of the BDS movement, declares that some of Israel's "racist" and "sadistic" actions against the Palestinians "are reminiscent of common Nazi practices against the Jews."[9] The charge is damning, but no more so than similar charges made by numerous others today. Writing in *Haaretz* in March 2014, the Hebrew University historian, Daniel Blatman, even declared that a "racist cancer. . .has spread deep into Israeli society" and "Israel is sliding toward an apartheid regime." In the eyes of many, he is certain, "Israel no longer has a place in the family of enlightened nations. It has become the South Africa of the 21st century."[10]

Evident here is an extreme form of verbal violence directed against an Israel transfigured into a monster state. The French linguist Georges Elia Sarfati has offered a perceptive analysis of the character and appeal of this rhetoric:

> A number of key equations dominate anti-Zionist discourse. The master one. . .is "Zionism equals Nazism." A second equation was derived from the first: "Zionism equals racism." A third equation is "Zionism is colonialism." A fourth one is "Zionism is imperialism". . . . These four distinct equations can be synthesized into one: the "Zionist, fascist, racist and colonial state". . . . These equivalencies are so evil because they attach the four major negative characteristics of Western history in the last century—Nazism, racism, colonialism, and imperialism—to the State of Israel. . . . If one tries to summarize this, the conclusion must be: "the less Israel, the more peace."[11]

Like all countries, Israel has its shortcomings, but nothing the country has done to date warrants putting it in the company of Verwoerd's South Africa or Hitler's Germany. With the growing normalization of anti-Zionist discourse, though, that is just where the country finds itself. Deeply embedded in the minds and speech acts of numbers of people, anti-Zionism has become both a cultural given and a social expectation in some circles. Linked by its advocates to anti-racism, anti-Zionism finds sanction through invocations of the Holocaust. For instance, Samer Ali, a professor of Middle Eastern Studies at the University of Texas and the moderator of a pro-boycott

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